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QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

Question #	Reference/Section (Page, #, etc.)	Question	Response
1	Section L	**Eligibility at the Proposal Deadline:** DFARS 252.204-7025(b) requires CMMC Level 2 (Self) status prior to award, while paragraph (d) requires applicable CMMC unique identifiers (UIDs) in the proposal. Will an offeror without completed Level 2 (Self) status or an applicable UID at the proposal deadline remain eligible for evaluation and award if it completes the assessment and submits the required UID and SPRS affirmation before award? Or will the absence of that information at proposal submission render the proposal unacceptable?	Under DFARS 252.204-7025, an offeror will be rendered ineligible for award if the CMMC unique identifier (UID) is missing from the proposal at the submission deadline. While CMMC Level 2 (Self) status must be active prior to award, paragraph (d) explicitly mandates providing the UID in the proposal itself. Because the UID cannot be generated in SPRS without a completed assessment, the absence of this information at proposal submission constitutes a material deficiency that cannot be cured before award.

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2	Section L	**How to address an assessment in progress:** If completion after proposal submission is permitted, what information must the offeror include in its initial proposal, and in which volume? Please identify the deadline and process for providing the completed assessment information and confirm whether it may be supplied during the pre-award responsibility determination without requiring discussions.	The Government confirms that an offeror with a CMMC Level 2 assessment actively in progress at the time of proposal submission may satisfy the solicitation's requirements by documenting their current assessment status, CAGE code, and projected milestone schedule in Volume I. The hard deadline to achieve the required CMMC status is prior to contract award, at which point the offeror must have uploaded their completed score and Affirmation of Continuous Compliance into SPRS and formally provided their CMMC Unique Identifier (UID) to the Contracting Officer. Because validating this completed SPRS record is a matter of prospective contractor responsibility under FAR Subpart 9.1, the Government may request, verify, and clarify this information during the pre-award responsibility determination without triggering formal "discussions" or requiring proposal revisions under FAR 15.306.

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3	Section L	**Conditional Level 2 (Self) status:** Will current Conditional Level 2 (Self) status, supported by the required SPRS affirmation and a qualifying Plan of Action and Milestones, satisfy the requirement for base-contract award? Or must the offeror achieve Final Level 2 (Self) status before award? If Conditional status is acceptable, please confirm the applicable deadline for achieving Final status.	Yes, a current Conditional Level 2 (Self) status - supported by the required SPRS affirmation and a qualifying Plan of Action and Milestones satisfies the requirement for base-contract award. The offeror is not required to achieve Final Level 2 (self) status prior to award. The mandatory deadline for achieving Final status is 180 calendar days from the Conditional CMMC Status Date.
4	Section L	**Requirements for an unpopulated joint venture:** For an unpopulated SBA-approved mentor-protégé JV, may the requirement be satisfied through a JV member's assessed information system when the JV's contract activities, personnel, and information are included within the assessment scope? Please clarify whether the JV may provide the member's CMMC UID or must establish a separate assessment record, UID, CAGE-code association, and affirmation in SPRS.	Yes, an unpopulated SBA-approved mentor-protégé JV may satisfy the requirement through a JV's member's assessed information system, provided all JV contract performance, personal access, and CUI/FCI are fully encompassed within that system's assessment scope.
5	Section L	**Use of a dedicated assessed environment:** May the JV limit its assessment scope to a dedicated contract-performance environment used by designated personnel from both member companies, provided all contract FCI/CUI and applicable supporting assets are appropriately included in scope? Must	Yes, the Joint Venture may limit its assessment scope to a dedicated contract-performance environment. The individual JV member companies do not need

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		both JV members separately maintain Level 2 status if their other systems will not process, store, or transmit contract FCI/CUI?	to separately maintain CMMC Level 2 status for their independent corporate systems, provided those corporate systems never process, store, or transmit contract CUI.
6	Section L	**Use of a subcontractor-provided environment:** If a proposed subcontractor provides an appropriately assessed environment that covers the prime's contract activities and personnel access, may the prime use that environment to satisfy this requirement? If so, what separate CMMC status, SPRS records, and affirmations must the prime maintain?	A prime contractor may utilize an appropriately assessed subcontractor-provided environment to satisfy CUI-handling requirements, provided all contract-related processing, storage, and transmission remaining strictly confined within that assessed boundary. The prime must still maintain a CMMC Level 1 status under it's own CAGE code, submit a Level 1 self assessment score in SPRS and execute annual compliance affirmations in SPRS for its own Level 1 environment and continuously verify that the subcontractor maintains an active Level 2 affirmation.

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7	Section L	**Timing of Compliance and anticipated award:** Please confirm whether the required CMMC status must be established before base MAC award or whether any requirement may be deferred until an applicable task-order award. What is the Government's anticipated timeframe for base MAC awards?	The CMMC requirements must be met at the time of the basic MAC award rather than deferred to task-order awards. The Government's current target timeframe for the basic MAC award is June 2027.
8	Section L	**Subcontractor compliance:** Must proposed subcontractors demonstrate applicable CMMC status with the prime's proposal, before base MAC award, or before award of their respective subcontracts? Please clarify the required level for subcontractors receiving only FCI versus those receiving CUI.	Subcontractors are not required to demonstrate CMMC status as part of the prime offeror's proposal or before award. However, the prime contractor must ensure that each subcontractor has the applicable current CMMC status before the subcontractor processes, stores, or transmits CUI in performance.
9	Section M, Factor 1	**Factor 1- Desired Additional Competencies:** Section M.8, Factor 1, paragraph (3)(b), identifies six major specific tasks under Sections C.3.2 through C.3.7. However, paragraph (3)(c), Desired Additional Competencies, refers to five major specific tasks. Please confirm whether the desired additional competencies will be evaluated across all six task areas identified in paragraph (3)(b).	Please see revised Section M.
10	Attachment J-16	What is the size of the project survey area? What are the maximum water depths within the project area to be surveyed?	Please see revised J-16.

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11	Attachment J-16	For logistics and coordination planning, what is the general project location? If Hawaii, what island?	Please see revised J-16.
12	Attachment J-16	Previous Surveys Table 1 is blank, will the government provide information for Table 1 or confirm that no information is available?	Please see revised J-16.
13	Attachment J-16	What is the intended period of performance or duration of the project?	Please see revised J-16.
14	Attachment J-16 & Attachment J-21	Tasks listed in J-21 Sample Project Price Sheet do not match J-16 Sample Project PWS tasks. Can government please clarify which set of tasks should be used for pricing and revise/reissue J-21 or J-16 as appropriate?	Please find revised J-21 Sample Project Price Sheet which aligns with J-16, Sample Project PWS
15	Section M, Factor 1	Under 4.A there is reference to six (6) Work Elements under 4.B. there is reference to five (5) work elements. Please clarify in conjunction with Tasks in J-21 and J-16.	Please see revised Section M.

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16	Section L	Regarding DFARS 252.237-7023 - Continuation of Essential Services. The provision states, in part, "(b) The Government has identified all, or a portion of the contractor services performed under this contract as essential contractor services in support of mission essential functions. These services are listed in attached Section C." However, Section C does not identify any listed services, in whole or in part, as essential. As a general rule prescribed in DFARS 237.7602, "the designation of services as essential contractor services will not apply to an entire contract but will apply only to those service functions that have been specifically identified as essential contractor services…." Please specifically identify the Mission-Essential Contractor Services in Section C.	Please see revised Section L.
17	Section L	L.8 indicates plan to be provided as part of Volume II. L.1.c Volume II does not indicate a location in the TOC/tab structure as listed. Should the Essential Contractor Services Plan be included as an added tab (5) in this Volume? There is not a basis of evaluation reference for the Essential Contractor Services Plan, will it be evaluated on an acceptable/unacceptable basis like the recent NAVFAC PAC Natural Resource Technical Services MAC solicitation?	Please see revised Section L.
18	Section L	Language in these sections refers to Section M.8., the solicitation does not have a Section M.8 that we can find. Should this reference be M7?	Please see revised Section L.

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19	Section M, Factor 1	Page 64-65, c. states “Desired Additional Competencies. The offeror will be evaluated more favorably on experience that involves two or more subtasks within the five major specific tasks described in section (3)b.” There are currently six major specific tasks listed in (3)a. and (3).b.. Can the government please clarify which five or what the number of major tasks should be?	Please see revised Section M.
20	Attachment J-2	J-2 list has qualifications more aligned to natural resources/terrestrial biology (e.g. - Technical Biologist with wildlife qualifications, Entomologist, Arborist, etc.). It is significantly different than the sources sought. Will the government reissue the J-2 Attachment?	Please see revised J-2.
21	Attachment J-14	The pdf J-14 Attachment issued with the solicitation has "N62742-27-R-1801, Attachment J-14" left justified within the 1" header/margin. This also occurs on the J-15 and J-20. There is language regarding 1" margins on all four sides of the page in various parts of the solicitation. Please confirm we can include the solicitation number and attachment numbers in the 1" margin of our submission.	Confirmed, the solicitation and attachment numbers may be included in the 1" margin of the submission.

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22	Section L	Language in M7, Factors 1, 2, and 5 refer to 8.5" x 11" pages, utilize one inch margins on all four sides of the page and print type no less than font size 11. When following the font/page format, does the fonts for everything outside the body text need to follow the required font for compliance? For example: Can information in headers and footers be smaller than font size 11? If tables or graphics are used may they be smaller than font size 11? This has been permitted by NAVFAC PAC solicitations in the past.	The font size requirements apply primarily to the body of the text of the proposal. Alternative font sizes are allowed, offerors must ensure that all submitted materials adhere strictly to the overall document constraints.
23	Section L	In addition to the page number in the footer, please confirm that the statement required under (b) identified to be in the "legend", should be included in the 1" footer/margin as appropriate, and can be in smaller than 11 point font.	Confirmed, in addition to the page number, the statement required under (b) may be placed in the 1-inch footer/margin, as appropriate and may be in a font size smaller than 11 point font.
24	Section M, Factor 1	Do we need to include a Letter of Commitment for Key Personnel who work for the Offeror?	No, see Section M. A letter of commitment shall be provided for each proposed key personnel, including subcontractor key personnel, who do not currently work for the Offeror.
25	Attachment J-15	The solicitation clearly states that the page limit for Factor 1, Attachment J-14 is 15 pages. What is the page limit for Attachment J-15?	See Section M. The Offeror shall not submit more than four (4) pages single-sided per Key Personnel.

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26	Attachment J-2	Attachment J-2 Minimum Professional Qualifications includes minimum qualifications for both an Entomologist and Arborist. Please confirm whether these labor categories are intended requirements under this solicitation, or if their inclusion in Attachment J-2 was inadvertent. Other expected qualifications, such as Marine Biologist or Scientific Diver, are not included Please confirm if there any additional roles or qualifications that should be included.	Please see revised J-2.
27	Section M, Factor 2 - Sample Project	What is the linkage between the sample project and the 5 projects we are presenting in J-14?	The five (5) projects presented in Attachment J-14 and the Sample project are separate submittal requirements with no direct operational linkage. The J-14 projects should demonstrate the offeror's historical experience while the Sample Project should demonstrate the offeror's technical approach to executing the requirements of this solicitation.
28	Section M, Factor 2 - Sample Project	Please confirm the requirements that the sample project could not be staffed by specialist who would require travel to reach the hypothetical project location.	The solicitation does not prohibit proposed key personnel from traveling to the hypothetical project location. If an offeror is proposing to have key personnel travel to the project location, please be sure to account for all

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			associated travel costs in the proposal
29	Section M, Factor 2 - Sample Project	Factor 2 requires submission of Attachment J-15 for each individual identified on Attachment J-17. Since J-17 contains assignments lines for up to 24 personnel, and each J-15 requires multiple pages, the resulting submission could be substantial. Please clarify whether J-15s are required for all personnel listed on J-17 or only for select key personnel supporting the sample project. If J-15s are required for all listed personnel, please confirm the applicable page limitation for this submiss requirement.	Offerors are not required to complete all lines on Attachment J-17. Attachment J-17 should only be populated with the specific personnel proposed to perform work on the Sample Project. Consequently, Attachment J-15 is required only for those select personnel identified on Attachment J-17 who will actively support the execution of the Sample Project. Attachment J-15 forms submitted in support of Factor 2 personnel shall not exceed 10-single sided pages per personnel.

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30	Section L	Page 59 of the RFP, paragraph L.8 states that the Essential Contractor Services is to be provided as a part of Volume II. Please clarify how this will be evaluated as it is not mentioned in Section M, Evaluation Factors for Award.	Please see revised Section L.
31	Section M, Factor 1 - Experience	Page 64 of the RFP, paragraph M7.3.A(2)a states “Clearly indicate whether the project was performed by the offeror or team subcontractor (see Note 4 above on applicability of subcontractor experience) and list which of the Section C Specific Tasks were performed in each contract or task order submitted in response to Factor 1.” Is the reference to “Note 4 above” an error? Please provide the appropriate corresponding paragraph.	See revised Section M
32	Section M, Factor 1 & 2	Page 64 of the RFP, paragraph M7.3.A(2)b states “The Offeror shall not submit more than four (4) pages single-sided per Key Personnel.” Page 66 of the RFP, paragraph M7.3.B(2)b. states “Attachment J-15 forms submitted in support of Factor 2 personnel shall not exceed 10 single-sided pages per personnel. Submissions should remain concise and relevant.” Please clarify that the government expects 10-page J-15 forms submitted for Factor 2, Sample Project, but 4-page J-15 forms submitted for Factor 1, Experience.	Confirmed, the page limits started in the RFP are correct as written. Factor 1 (Experience): Attachment J-15 is limited to a maximum of four (4) pages single-sided per Key Personnel. Factor 2 (Sample Project): Attachment J-15 forms submitted shall not exceed ten

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			(10) single-sided pages per person. However, offerors are reminded that submissions should remain concise, relevant and directly tailored to the requirements of the Sample Project.
33	Section M, Factor 1 & 2	Page 66 of the RFP, paragraph M7.3.B(2)b. states “Use Attachment J-15, Personnel Experience/Qualifications, for each individual listed on Attachment J-17 to demonstrate their experience and qualifications. Even if an individual was previously included as Key Personnel under Factor 1, a separate and complete Attachment J-15 must be submitted for them under Factor 2 if they are also proposed for the Sample Project." Are the Attachment J-15 forms for the Principle and Project Manager expected to be identical in both Factors 1 and 2?	Attachment J-15 forms submitted for the Principal and Project Manager (Biological) under Factor 2 are not required to be identical to those submitted under Factor 1, though offerors may submit the same form if it adequately demonstrates the individual's qualifications for both Factors.
34	Section M, Factor 1	Page 64 of the RFP, paragraph M7.3.A(3)b states “To be considered for this contract, the Offeror must demonstrate experience (in project AND key personnel experience) in one subtask within each of the following six (6) major specific tasks described in Section C of this solicitation by completing Attachment J-14.” Paragraph M7.3.A(3)c states “The offeror will be evaluated more favorably on experience that involves two or more subtasks within the five major specific tasks described in section (3)b.” Please clarify if there are five or six major specific tasks and if 3.7: GIS Mapping is a major specific task.	Please see revised Section M.

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35	Section C	Please clarify the definition of "subtask" as used in the solicitation. Section C.3.2 identifies subtasks 3.2.1 through 3.2.10, and Section C.3.3 identifies subtasks 3.3.1 through 3.3.5. However, Sections C.3.4, C.3.5, C.3.6, and C.3.7 are presented without numbered subtasks and instead contain narrative descriptions of services. For purposes of proposal preparation and compliance with any subtask-related requirements or limitations, should each individual service described within these narrative sections be considered a separate subtask, or does the term "subtask" apply only to those items specifically identified and numbered as subtasks within the Performance Work Statement?	The term "subtask" applies only to those items specifically identified and numerically labeled (e.g., 3.2.1, 3.3.1) within the Performance Work Statement (PWS / Section C). For Sections C.3.4, C.3.5, C.3.6, and C.3.7, each of these parent sections is to be treated as a single, consolidated task. Offerors are not required to subdivide or break out the narrative descriptions of services within these sections into separate, unnumbered subtasks for proposal preparation.
36	Section M, Factor 1	Page 65 of the RFP, paragraph M7.3.E(10) states “Resumes of Key Personnel where the Key Personnel individuals' qualifications significantly exceed minimum requirements set forth in Section C. paragraphs 3.2 to 3.7, respectively, may be evaluated more favorably.” Please confirm that the reference to “Section C. paragraphs 3.2 to 3.7” is an error. Please confirm that the minimum requirements referenced are the applicable key personnel qualification requirements identified in Attachment J-2.	Please see revised Section M.
37	Attachment J-14	Attachment J-14 Block 10 lists major specific tasks 3.2 through 3.6. Please clarify if there are five or six major specific tasks and if 3.7: GIS Mapping is a major specific task.	Please see Revised J-14

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38	Attachment J-14	Page 64 of the RFP, paragraph M7.3.A(3)b states “To be considered for this contract, the Offeror must demonstrate experience (in project AND key personnel experience) in one subtask within each of the following six (6) major specific tasks described in Section C of this solicitation by completing Attachment J-14.” Should we modify Attachment J-14 Block 10 to include the subtasks listed in Section C.3.2 and C.3.3?	Please see Revised J-14
39	Attachment J-15	Attachment J-15 states “Please see Section M, Paragraph M8, Technical Evaluation Factors (FACTORS 1-5), subparagraph 3A(1), for the definition of recent, relevant projects...” The definition of “recent relevant project” is included in paragraph M7.3.E(1). Please confirm the verbiage contained therein is inclusive off all evaluation factors for a "recent relevant project" example.	Please see Revised J-15. As described in Section M, a recent relevant project is a project whose scope of work is similar to the types of projects that may be ordered against this MAC that require the performance of one or more of the Specific Tasks described in Section C. paragraphs 3.2 through 3.7.
40	Attachment J-16	Attachment J-16, Sample Project Performance Work Statement, does not identify a specific project location. Please provide the project location, along with the total acreage within the proposed project footprint, including both direct and indirect impact areas. This information is necessary for offerors to develop an accurate project cost estimate and appropriately assess staffing and resource requirements.	Please see revised J-16.

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41		Attachment J-17 states "As required by Section M, paragraph M8.3.C(2)b, fill in the names of all key personnel to be assigned responsibility for the tasks listed in Attachment J-16 Sample Project Performance Work Statement (Biological and Benthic Habitat Surveys in Support of Maintenance Dredging) and the firm that employs that key personnel." Please confirm the correct paragraph in the RFP is M7.3.B(2)b.	Please see Revised J-17
42	L.6 Teaming/Joint-Venture/ Mentor-Protégé Agreements and Approvals	Section L.6 states that corporations, joint ventures, partnerships, and other similar entities may not be a party to more than one offeror. Could you please confirm whether a firm that is a member of a joint venture submitting an offer may also participate as a subcontractor to a different offeror without violating this provision?	A firm that is a member of a Joint Venture submitting an offer as a prime contractor is not prohibited from participating as a non-exclusive subcontractor to a different prime offeror under Section L.6, provided the following conditions are met: 1) The firm participates strictly in a subcontractor capacity with no ownership, governance, or prime privity in the competing offeror; and 2) the firm maintains appropriate organizational firewalls to protect proprietary pricing and technical data between the competing teams.

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43	Section M	The solicitation references Section M.8 for the technical and price factor submission requirements; however, Section M ends at Paragraph M.7. Can the Government confirm that references to Section M.8 in the solicitation are intended to refer to Section M.7?	Confirmed. References were updated to refer to Section M.7.
44	Attachment J-15	Attachment J-15 states, “Please see Section M, Paragraph M8, Technical Evaluation Factors (FACTORS 1-5), subparagraph 3A(1), for the definition of recent, relevant projects.” However, Section M ends at Paragraph M.7. Should the correct reference be Section M.7.3A(3)e?	Please see revised Attachment J-15.
45	Attachment J-17	Attachment J-17 references Section M, Paragraph M8.3C(2)b, for identifying the names and employing firms of key personnel assigned responsibility for tasks listed in Attachment J-16, Sample Project PWS. However, Section M ends at Paragraph M.7. What is the correct intended citation?	Please see revised Attachment J-17.
46	Section M, Factor 1	For Factor 1, must the offeror's relevant project experience and proposed key personnel experience each independently demonstrate all six minimum required competencies identified in Sections C.3.2 through C.3.7, or will the Government evaluate the combined experience of the offeror's projects and key personnel to determine whether the six competencies have been met?	The offeror's submitted project experience and the proposed Key Personnel experience must each independently demonstrate all six minimum required competencies identified in Sections C.3.2 through C.3.7. The corporate experience and the personnel experience are evaluated as separate, standalone requirements under Factor 1, and the credentials of

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			one cannot be used to offset a deficiency in the other.
47	Section M, Factor 1	Section C.3.2, Scientific Field Work and Associated Analyses, identifies ten subtasks, and Section C.3.3, Supporting Services and Technical Analyses, identifies five subtasks. However, Sections C.3.4 through C.3.7 do not identify separately numbered subtasks. For purposes of evaluating minimum required experience under Factor 1, will the Government evaluate Sections C.3.4 through C.3.7 at the major specific task level?	Yes, for the purposes of evaluating minimum required experience under Factor 1, Sections C.3.4 through C.3.7 will be evaluated at the major specific task level (i.e., at the primary section header level: Section C.3.4, Section C.3.5, Section C.3.6, and Section C.3.7), rather than against individual unnumbered sub-elements
48	Section M, Factor 2	Attachment J-16, Sample Project PWS (revised July 2026), does not identify specific key personnel positions. What positions or roles does the Government require offerors to identify as key personnel in Attachment J-17 for the Factor 2 Staffing Plan?	For Attachment J-17, offerors are required to identify the same Key Personnel positions specified in Factor 1: Principal and Project Manager (Biological). Beyond these mandatory roles, offerors are required to propose whatever additional personnel, technical specialists and labor categories they deem necessary to successfully perform the complete scope of work outlined

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			in Attachment J-16. All proposed personnel must meet or exceed the minimum qualifications, experience and certification requirements outlined in Attachment J-2.
49	Section M, Factor 1 & 2	Must the key personnel proposed under Factor 1 (Principal and Project Manager [Biological]) be the same individuals proposed as key personnel under Factor 2, or may offerors propose different individuals for the sample project?	No, offerors are not required to use the same individuals across both factors. However, regardless of what individuals are proposed, offerors must submit a forma Teaming Agreement for any proposed subcontractors and a signed Letter of Commitment for any proposed personnel who are not currently employed by the prime offeror to be considered as key personnel.
50	Section M, Factor 2	For Factor 2, may offerors propose additional key personnel beyond the two positions identified under Factor 1, including multiple Project Managers or technical specialists, to provide expertise and assume responsibility for different tasks identified in Attachment J-16?	Yes, Offerors may propose additional Key Personnel beyond the positions mandated in Factor 1 if they believe it strengthens their technical approach for the Sample Project.
51	Attachment J-16	Attachment J-16 states that Table 1 identifies previous biological and benthic surveys conducted within or adjacent to the project	Please see revised Attachment J-16.

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		area; however, the table contains no survey entries. Will the Government provide the referenced survey information and available supporting reports or datasets for use in developing the sample-project technical approach and price?	
52	Section L	Does the font face and size requirements extend to the forms. They are currently set at Helvetica (and when text is put in, the font size will shrink to accommodate the area.	The font face and size requirements do not extend to the forms. However, please ensure all text is legible.
53	Section L	Are firms allowed to use firm branded templates for the content that will not be submitted in forms, pending we use the font face and size requirements?	Yes, offerors are permitted to use firm-branded templates for non-form content provided all formatting instructions (font size, margin and page limitations) are adhered to.
54	Section M, Factor 2	For our personnel that we'll be presenting in Factor 2 Sample Project, we just need resumes, right? Format doesn't matter, either the Tech format, SF33 format, or any format will do because we have to modify them to be in the J-15 format anyway, right?	No, offerors must submit resumes utilizing Attachment J-15. Resumes submitted in alternative formats will not be accepted and may result in the candidate being determined non-compliant.
55	Attachment J-16	J-16 Sample Project: Technical approach and Pricing will want to know: A) Location B) approximate position of maintenance dredging perimeter relative to adjacent marine resources (i.e., pricing for 2 km of adjacent seagrass/coral or only 200 meters of adjacent	A) Please see revised Attachment J-16. B) This is what the offeror should be generating and establishing in their proposal C) N/A, the dredge volume does not influence the survey

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		seagrass/coral?) C) approximate volume of maintenance dredging (e.g., related to duration and extent of indirect impacts, and extent of pre-dredge surveys) D) likely sediment disposal technique (e.g., ODMDS, beneficial re-use, de-watering & upland, contaminant remediation) (related to extent of indirect impacts, and extent of pre-dredge surveys)	D) N/A, disposal does not influence survey site. Use revised Attachment J-16 area only.
56	Attachment J-16 & Attachment J-21	The work elements in Attachment J-21 do not match the tasks in Attachment J-16. For example, J-21 includes “Coral Monitoring and Maintenance Surveys” and “Water Quality Monitoring,” which do not appear in the PWS. PWS Task 3 (Focused Biological Surveys) and Task 4a (Report Writing) have no matching work element. How should offerors map the J-16 tasks to the J-21 work elements? Will the Government issue a revised J-16 or J-21?	See response to Q14.
57	Section M, Factor 2	Paragraph 4.A(1) of the Price Evaluation Factor refers to six work elements, while paragraph 4.B(2) refers to five. Attachment J-21 contains worksheets with four and five work elements. How many work elements should offerors price, and which worksheet should be submitted?	Offerors shall propose a price for five (5) work elements utilizing the revised Attachment J-21. See Amendment 0001.
58	Attachment J-16	Attachment J-16 does not identify the installation or harbor where the sample project would take place. Location affects the applicable wage determination, vessel and dive logistics, and taxes. Where is the sample project located, or what location should offerors use to develop their technical approach and price?	See revised Attachment J-21.

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59	Attachment J-16	Section M.7.3B(2)c states that offerors shall not make assumptions. However, Attachment J-16 does not provide the information needed to estimate field effort and labor hours. Can the Government provide the approximate size of the dredge footprint and survey area, the depth range, and the number of mooring devices and debris items to be surveyed?	See revised Attachment J-21.
60	Attachment J-21	Attachment J-21 states that lines may be added under Other Direct Costs (“Add lines as necessary”). May offerors also add lines under Labor and Specialized Services in each work element?	Yes, offerors may add rows to Labor and Specialized Services in the Attachment J-21 to reflect their technical approach and proposed staff. However, offerors must not alter the underlying formulas within the worksheet.
61		For awards under the Small Business Set-Aside (SBSA) Division, please confirm whether services performed by a 501(c)(3) nonprofit university or nonprofit research corporation must be included in the amount subcontracted to entities that are not similarly situated under FAR 52.219-14 and 13 CFR 125.6. For awards under the Small Business Set-Aside (SBSA) Division, please confirm whether services performed by a 501(c)(3) nonprofit university or nonprofit research corporation must be included in the amount subcontracted to entities that are not similarly situated under FAR 52.219-14 and 13 CFR 125.6. Additionally, please clarify whether compliance with the limitations on subcontracting will be assessed at the individual	Confirming that any services performed by a 501(c)(3) nonprofit university or nonprofit research corporation must be counted as subcontracted to a non-similarly situated entity. Pursuant to FAR 52.219-14 and 13 CFR § 125.1, a "similarly situated entity" is defined strictly as a subcontractor that is a small business concern under the same small business program status required by the prime contract. Because 501(c)(3) nonprofits are not

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		task-order level or across the applicable MAC IDIQ contract performance period.	organized for profit, they do not qualify as "small business concerns"; under SBA standards. Pursuant to FAR 52.219-14(f)(1), compliance with the limitations on subcontracting will be assessed across the applicable contract performance period (i.e., by the end of the base term and then by the end of each subsequent option period) across the MAC IDIQ. Compliance is not evaluated on an individual task-order-by-task-order basis.

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62		A 3-week time extension is requested due to: 1) the number of questions that are pending, 2) this is a "1st generation MAC" with no prior similar contract (unlike other PAC MACs). While the Section C task names were known from sources sought and pre-solicitation; the task descriptions, subtasks, and relative importance were not available to industry, considering this new detailed information in conjunction with the questions and timing of responses will have a large impact on offeror proposals.	The proposal deadline has been extended to December 7, 2026.

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63	Attachment J-21	This section refers to electronic cost proposal files. 1- Please confirm the J-21 excel file should be submitted as a .pdf file embedded in Volume (2) and that the offeror should not submit an excel file. If an excel file is required, is it to be submitted as a separate file? 2- The J-21 excel file provided is font Arial font, 10 point. This section states "If submitting PDF documents with the electronic proposal, the text shall be a font of Arial, 11 point." Should we modify the excel file for Arial, 11 point?	1 - Confirmed. Attachment J-21 shall be submitted strictly as a .pdf file within Volume I. 2 - Offerors are not required to modify the font size of the Attachment J-21 Excel file to Arial 11-point. Government-furnished Excel templates and spreadsheets should be submitted in their original format.
64	Section L	Other sections (e.g. - Factors 1, 2, & 5) refer to font 11 point or larger but do not specify Arial. Many of the J forms are not Arial font. Please confirm that any common 11 point font or larger (e.g. Times New Roman, etc.) can be used for the Volumes I, II, and III body text.	The Government clarifies that the body text for Volumes I, II, and III must be submitted in Arial, 11-point font. However, offerors are not required to alter the original fonts or formatting of the Government-furnished "J" forms; these templates should be completed and submitted in their native format as provided.
65	Attachment J-13	Can the Navy provide the J-13 SBSP template in word format?	Yes

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66	Past Performance Questionnaire	For a Factor 1, Project (J-14) for work performed as a subcontractor, please confirm that a PPQ from the prime contractor or the government may be provided when no subcontractor CPARS exists, when the prime contractor CPARS does not explicitly rate or detail the subcontractor's performance, or no CPARS is available from the prime.	Confirmed. For work performed as a subcontractor, where a CPARS rating is unavailable or does not explicitly describe the subcontractor's performance, offerors may submit a Past Performance Questionnaire (PPQ) completed by the Prime Contractor.
67	Attachment J-15	Sample Project J-15s states, " shall not exceed 10 single-sided pages per personnel" and "Submissions should remain concise and relevant." 1- Is the 10 single-sided pages limit a typo, was something less intended? 2-If 10 pages is the "shall not exceed limit", please confirm the Offeror may add blocks/expand the Factor 2, J-15s for additional project and/or information, as long as information is concise and relevant?	1 - No 2 - Offerors may expand the rows/blocks within the Attachment J-15 form to provide additional relevant project information, provided the entire submitted volume does not exceed the overall 10 single-sided page limit.
68	Section G	Section G2.2 indicates funding source (US or GOJ) will be a primary factor in determining whether a task order will be competed within the SBSA or UR division. The pre-solicitation (05 October 2026) noted potential need for different types of services, as well as those contractors capable of successfulling executing those services may be considered in determining how task orders will be competed, but did not mention funding source. We understand work in Guam and CNMI may be funded by US or GOJ sources depending on program. The marine resource technical services tasks in Section C. can be high	See revised Section G. The Government clarifies that funding source will not be used to determine the competition pool. All task order requirements will first be evaluated for competition within the Small Business Set-Aside (SBSA) division. In accordance with the "Rule of Two," if market

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		complexity, large size, logistics intense, and may be identified as mission essential. Can the government confirm intent to use funding source as a primary factor to determine how task orders will be completed within divisions or clarify as appropriate?	research indicates there is not a reasonable expectation of receiving competitive offers from two or more qualified small business awardees capable of performing the highly complex or logistically intense technical services, the requirement will then be competed within the Unrestricted (UR) division.
69	Section E	The Contractor shall submit to the Contracting Officer a General Quality Control Plan (QCP) as part of the Technical Proposal." A QCP submission requirement is currently not included in Factor 2, Sample Project, as a submission requirement. If a QCP is required, please confirm where it should be included and its page limitation (if there is one).	A Quality Control Plan (QCP) is not required to be submitted with the initial proposal for Factor 2.
70	Section L	Section L.1 references Section M.8 on three occasions, and Attachment J-17 references Section M, paragraph M8.3.C(2)(b). However, Section M.8 does not appear in the solicitation. Please confirm whether Section M.8 was inadvertently omitted or whether these references should be corrected to another paragraph. If omitted, please provide the missing section or issue an amendment.	See revised Section L

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71	Section M, Factor 3	Does the Navy consider the Total Case Rate (TCR) the same as the OSHA Total Recordable Incident Rate (TRIR)? If not, please define the distinction between TCR and TRIR and provide the required calculation method for TCR.	The Total Case Rate (TCR), often referred to by OSHA and the Bureau of Labor Statistics (BLS) data as the Total Recordable Incident Rate (TRIR), are the same metric. Both measure the total number of work-related injuries and illnesses. TCR = (Total Number of OSHA Recordable Cases × 200,000) ÷ Total Employee Labor Hours Worked
72	Attachment J-2	Attachment J-2 identifies the following minimum professional qualification categories: Principal, Project Manager (Biological), Environmental Scientist, Technical Biologist, NEPA Planner, GIS Specialist, Entomologist, Hydrologist/Wetland Specialist, Arborist, Site Safety Officer, Editor, and Administrative Assistant Support. We understand that, under Factor 1, offerors are required to submit Attachment J-15 information for the Principal and Project Manager (Biological). Please clarify whether offerors are required to submit qualifications, resumes, or other supporting information for the remaining categories identified in Attachment J-2. If so, please specify where (in what Factor) and in what format this information should be provided. Additionally, please clarify whether all listed categories apply to this Marine Resource Technical Services solicitation, including categories such as Arborist and Entomologist, which do not appear to directly correspond to the primary marine-resource requirements described in Section C.	Please see revised Attachment J-2. Offerors are only required to submit Attachment J-15s for the Principal and Project Manager (Biological) for Factor 1. Offerors must submit Attachment J-15 for all key personnel proposed to perform work on the Factor 2 Sample Project. Not all labor categories in Attachment J-2 are required. Offerors should only propose and provide qualifications for the specific labor categories necessary to successfully execute Factor 2 Sample project.

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73	Attachments J-18 & J-19	Can an editable, unlocked Word versions of Attachments J-18 (Historical Small Business Utilization) and J-19 (Small Business Participation Commitment Document) be provided?	Yes